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Editors of Blockchains

Special Issue: Feature Papers in Blockchains 2026

Dear Editors,

Please consider our Review manuscript, "Blockchain-Assisted Mission Trust in Air-Surface-Underwater Unmanned Systems: A Review and Conceptual Framework," for publication in Blockchains and inclusion in the Special Issue "Feature Papers in Blockchains 2026."

Cooperation among unmanned aerial, surface, and underwater vehicles requires mission decisions to combine evidence across heterogeneous communication links, intermittent connectivity, and organizational boundaries. This narrative review connects research on trust and reputation, provenance, remote attestation, zero trust, and permissioned blockchains through the objects being assessed, the assurance claims involved, and the mission stages at which evidence is required.

The principal contribution is the Object-Assurance-Lifecycle (OAL) framework, which relates four trust objects to four assurance layers across six lifecycle stages. A typed dependency graph and context-temporal-graph reasoning loop organize evidence dependencies, shared failure causes, uncertainty, and reliance policy. A worked example illustrates acceptance and restriction decisions. A claim-specific evidence profile, six research hypotheses, and a proposed Cross-Domain Unmanned Trust Profile define an agenda for comparative evaluation and interoperability research.

The review identifies conditions under which permissioned blockchains can support membership management, attestation and provenance commitments, version coordination, audit, and reconciliation after network partition. It relates these functions to complementary controls for observation validity, endpoint protection, local safety, privacy, and governance. This conceptual synthesis addresses the journal's interests in blockchain applications, security, data governance, and new frameworks, and provides a basis for future implementation and empirical evaluation.

The manuscript and its contents have not been published in another journal and are not under consideration by any other journal. All authors have approved the manuscript and agree to its submission to Blockchains. The manuscript has not previously been submitted to an MDPI journal and has no preprint or conference version. Author information and declarations are provided on the following page for the Editorial Office.

Thank you for your consideration.

Sincerely,

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Blockchain-Assisted Mission Trust in Air-Surface-Underwater Unmanned Systems: A Review and Conceptual Framework

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Conceptualization, Shaowei Liu, Jing Wu and Chengnian Long; methodology, Shaowei Liu and Jing Wu; investigation, Shaowei Liu; writing - original draft preparation, Shaowei Liu; writing - review and editing, Shaowei Liu, Jing Wu, Tanren Liu, Shengqiang He, Yakun Ren and Chengnian Long; visualization, Shaowei Liu; supervision, Chengnian Long. All authors have read and approved the submitted manuscript.

Conflicts of interest

The authors declare no conflicts of interest.